



MONTHLY UPDATE

Rwanda: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-05 · 43 systems and instruments tracked, 13 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-05 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Two dates were fixed in July. Effective 14 July the central bank [migrated all domestic interoperable retail payments onto one rail](#) at a flat RWF 20; and on 28 July the ministry [fixed 30 June 2027 for the third-generation network shutdown](#). Cabinet approved an institute of computing on 24 July, and a development agency reported on 6 July that no national body assesses artificial-intelligence risk or monitors harms.

Infrastructure

The ministry [announced the legacy-network retirement plan on 28 July](#): third-generation service off nationwide on 30 June 2027, operator pilot shutdowns during 2026, and critical-system migration completed in the first half of 2027, with extensions temporary and regulator-approved only. December 2028 is the working date for the older network, expressly conditional on coverage, voice reliability including emergency calls, continuity of mobile money and payments, migration of dependent systems, and the availability of affordable handsets. A government-commissioned study found more than two million people could still be on that network in 2030 without a planned transition; the study is unpublished, so its method and definitions are unestablished. The ministry also published capability check codes and an institutional audit checklist covering messaging services, payment terminals, utility meters and vehicle trackers.

The technical precondition switched on days later: the dominant operator launched voice over fourth-generation networks, reported on 3 August, with no coverage, handset-base or subscriber figure and no completion date given. The source makes no reference to the sunset.

A subsea operator announced a 25,000 km system across fifteen countries on 9 July with no timeline disclosed; a landlocked country's exposure to it is backhaul rather than a landing. As at 30 July the World Bank's successor nine-year country framework is prepared but not launched, with no committed envelope on the record.

Digital public infrastructure

Effective 14 July the central bank [designated one rail as the national instant payment system](#) by directive, connecting 22 financial institutions bank to wallet to merchant in any direction, with a per-transaction ceiling. An interoperable bank-to-wallet transfer that could previously cost as much as RWF 5,000 now costs [a flat RWF 20 regardless of amount](#), about one US cent on the publisher's own conversion. The directive itself is not held.

The layer the rail does not touch moved the other way. Regulator statistics for the first quarter of 2026, reported on 31 July, put the second operator's share of the mobile-money market at 14.3% against 16.9% a year earlier, and its active agents at 48,847 against 53,316 — a contraction in the cash-in and cash-out network on which rural households depend, over exactly the period interoperability was meant to help.

The government's services portal was reported on 30 July as carrying [more than 600 services, of which more than 240 are paid, across 4,000 agents](#). The same account records the stack being sold abroad: two neighbours have adopted the electronic billing machine, a third is mid-adoption, and one state has taken the electronic procurement platform and is co-developing it. No revenue or contract value is disclosed for any adoption.

On 20 July an information society authority and a West African digital ministry identified artificial intelligence, electronic health and electronic commerce as areas to explore around that procurement platform — areas identified, nothing signed.

Governance and regulation

A development agency published on 6 July, from engagements run to March 2026, that Rwandan participants reported [no dedicated national organisation conducts artificial-intelligence risk assessments, evaluations or active monitoring of errors and harms](#) — while the technology is embedded in payments, judiciary filing, identity verification and service delivery — and that resolving an authentication error can take days or weeks. The report is qualitative and claims no representativeness.

Rwanda and a North African state signed an artificial-intelligence and digital-transformation memorandum on 10 July, with no funding, deliverable or timeline stated. The head of state was confirmed on 3 July as co-chair of an international commission on artificial intelligence, with no national work programme attached to the seat.

The internet governance forum convened in Kigali on 30 July under the domain registry; a regional body announced an internet governance blueprint for a steering committee in September 2026.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Cabinet [approved an institute of computing on 24 July](#), to open in September 2026 as an affiliated institute of the national university offering degrees in artificial intelligence and cyber security, with admission for the first two intakes limited to graduates of a single secondary coding academy at equal male and female representation. No capital budget, intake size or named international partner is published.

The information and communication sector [employed 19,000 workers in the second quarter of 2026 against about 12,000 a year earlier](#) — up 62.6% against 2.7% economy-wide, and still about 0.4% of total employment, against a sector target of 50,000 digital jobs by 2029.

At the internet governance forum on 30 July a ministry official said artificial intelligence is already in use in Rwandan health, education and fraud detection. The national agency approved in June still has no published structure, budget, law or implementation timeline.

As at 3 August the development bank is the sole committed backer, at US\$6m, of a venture debt fund that is not closed, with a further US\$3m near-committed; cheques run US\$300,000 to just under US\$1m, uncollateralised, at 9 to 12%. The figures are the fund manager's own and no commitment date is given.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

Formal financial access was reported at [96% of adults in 2024 against 48% in 2008](#), with 68.5% using a mobile wallet and only about 5% holding a bank account. Against that headline, the agent network contracted at the second operator over the year to March 2026, and the accounts-per-agent ratio widened.

The legacy-network retirement plan carries handset-affordability measures, which is the inclusion question the 30 June 2027 deadline turns on: the single figure that would show whether the deadline is achievable — the share of the handset base capable of voice over fourth-generation networks — has not been published by the operator, the ministry or the regulator.

Nothing was published in the month on school connectivity, which stands at 4,184 of 4,996 schools connected as at March 2026, leaving 812 mostly rural against a government target of 80%. The digital-ambassador programme that trained 1,567,034 citizens concluded its financing phase in May 2026 and no successor financing is held.

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